AI Connector Governance & Data Security

How Zenith Can Use Claude Connectors Without Exposing Client Data

Prepared for: Zenith Compliance Classification: Internal April 2026

1. WHERE WE ARE

Zenith has adopted Claude as the firm's preferred AI platform. Every advisor has a seat on our Claude Teams subscription. The team has been introduced to Claude and is beginning to use it for research, drafting, and general productivity work.

The next question is: **can we connect Claude to our client data systems?**

Compliance's concern is clear and legitimate:

> THE CONCERN
>
> **"We do not want client data leaving our systems and landing on Anthropic's servers. If we connect Claude to Google Drive, Wealthbox, or any system that holds client information, we risk data leakage. We need to understand exactly what a connector is, how it works, and how we prevent identifiable client data from reaching the AI."**

This document addresses that concern directly. The short answer: a properly built connector does not create data leakage. It *prevents* it. The rest of this document explains why.

2. THE PROBLEM WITHOUT CONNECTORS

Right now, Claude has no access to client data. That sounds safe. But consider what happens when an advisor wants to use Claude for client work *without* a connector:

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	RISK
1	Advisor opens a client statement in Google Drive	None yet
2	Advisor copies the holdings table from the PDF	None yet
3	Advisor pastes it into Claude: "Summarize this portfolio for John Smith, Acct #88923455"	**Client name, account number, and full holdings are now on Anthropic's servers**
4	Or: advisor uploads the PDF directly into Claude	**The entire raw document — with SSN, address, everything — is now on Anthropic's servers**

THE IRONY

Blocking connectors does not eliminate the risk. It increases it. Without a controlled path to client data, advisors will work around the limitation by copying and pasting — which is the exact scenario compliance wants to prevent. A connector gives the firm architectural control over what reaches Claude. Without one, the firm has only a policy and a hope that advisors follow it.

3. WHAT IS A CONNECTOR?

A connector is a piece of software that sits **between** Claude and an external data source. It is built by the firm, hosted on the firm's infrastructure, and controlled entirely by the firm. Claude does not connect to Google Drive or Wealthbox directly. Claude connects to *the firm's connector*, and the connector decides what to share.

Think of it like a front desk

Imagine Claude is a consultant sitting in the lobby. The consultant needs client data to do their work. They can't walk into the file room — they don't have a keycard. Instead, they submit a request to the front desk: "I need the Q1 holdings for Client 007."

The front desk (the connector) goes to the file room, pulls the folder, **removes the client's name, SSN, account numbers, and address**, photocopies only the holdings page, and brings it back to the consultant. The consultant does their analysis on that cleaned-up copy.

The consultant never enters the file room. They never see the original. They don't even know the client's name.

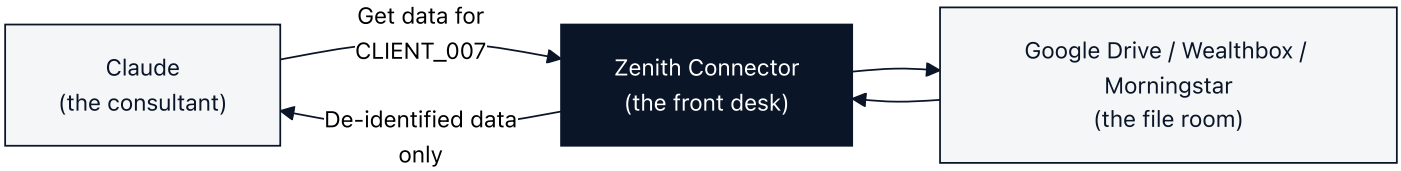

Figure 1 — Claude requests data from the connector. The connector fetches from the source, strips identifying information, and returns only what's needed.

The technical name

Anthropic calls this integration model the **Model Context Protocol (MCP)**. An MCP server is the technical term for what we are calling a "connector." It is an open standard — meaning the firm can build its own connectors using well-documented specifications, host them on the firm's own infrastructure, and maintain full control.

Claude Desktop and Claude.ai both support connectors natively. No additional software or special configuration is needed on the advisor's machine beyond connecting to the firm's approved connector.

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Connector	A firm-built, firm-hosted program that sits between Claude and a data source. It controls what Claude can see.
MCP Server	The technical name for a connector. MCP stands for Model Context Protocol — the standard that defines how connectors communicate with Claude.
MCP Tool	A specific function inside a connector. For example, "get portfolio review" or "check concentration risk." Each tool defines exactly what Claude can request and what the

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
	connector will return.

4. WHAT THE CONNECTOR DOES BEFORE RETURNING DATA

Every time Claude requests client information through a connector, six things happen inside the connector — automatically, before any data reaches Claude. This is the pipeline that prevents data leakage.

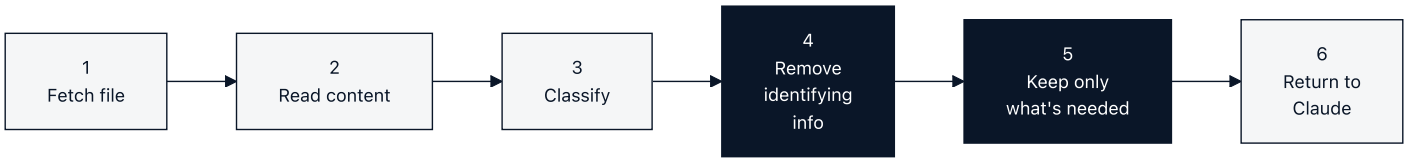

Figure 2 — Steps 4 and 5 (dark) are the critical data protection steps. They run every time, automatically.

1 **Fetch the file**

The connector retrieves the document from Google Drive (or Wealthbox, etc.). It verifies that the requesting advisor has permission to access this client's records.

2 **Read the content**

PDFs are converted to text. Spreadsheets are parsed. Google Docs are exported. The connector now has the raw content in structured form.

3 **Classify the document**

The connector determines what type of document this is, whether it contains personally identifiable information, and whether firm policy allows it to be processed by AI.

4 **Remove all identifying information**

Every name, account number, Social Security number, address, and date of birth is replaced with a code number or removed entirely. This is the most important step.

5 **Keep only what's needed**

If the advisor asked to "check allocation," the connector returns only the holdings table — not the entire document, not the cover page, not the disclosures.

6 **Return the cleaned data to Claude**

The de-identified, minimized data goes back to Claude. Claude analyzes it and presents a draft to the advisor for review.

5. WHAT CLAUDE SEES VS. WHAT IT DOES NOT

REAL DATA (IN GOOGLE DRIVE)	WHAT CLAUDE RECEIVES (VIA CONNECTOR)
~~John A. Smith~~	**CLIENT_007**
~~Acct # 88923455~~	**ACCT_01**
~~SSN 123-45-6789~~	**[REMOVED]**
~~123 Main Street, Apt 4B~~	**[REMOVED]**
~~DOB: 03/15/1968~~	**[REMOVED]**
US Equity ETF: 41%	US Equity ETF: 41%
Municipal Bonds: 15%	Municipal Bonds: 15%
Tech single stock: 18%	Tech single stock: 18%

IF ANTHROPIC'S SERVERS WERE BREACHED

An attacker would find: **"CLIENT_007 — US Equity ETF: 41%, Tech single stock: 18%."** There is no way to connect this to a real person. The code-number-to-identity mapping exists only inside the connector, on Zenith's infrastructure. It never leaves.

6. THE CLIENT CODE NUMBER SYSTEM

Advisors never type client names into Claude. They use internal code numbers that mean nothing outside the firm.

WHO / WHAT	WHAT THEY KNOW
The Advisor	Knows CLIENT_007 is John Smith (from their own client knowledge)
Claude	Knows CLIENT_007 exists as a valid code — nothing else. Cannot look up the real name.
The Connector	Knows CLIENT_007 = John Smith, knows which Drive files belong to that client, performs the de-identification. This mapping never leaves Zenith's servers.

If an advisor asked Claude "who is CLIENT_007?" — Claude would not know. That information does not exist anywhere in Claude's system. The connector resolves the identity internally and returns only de-identified data.

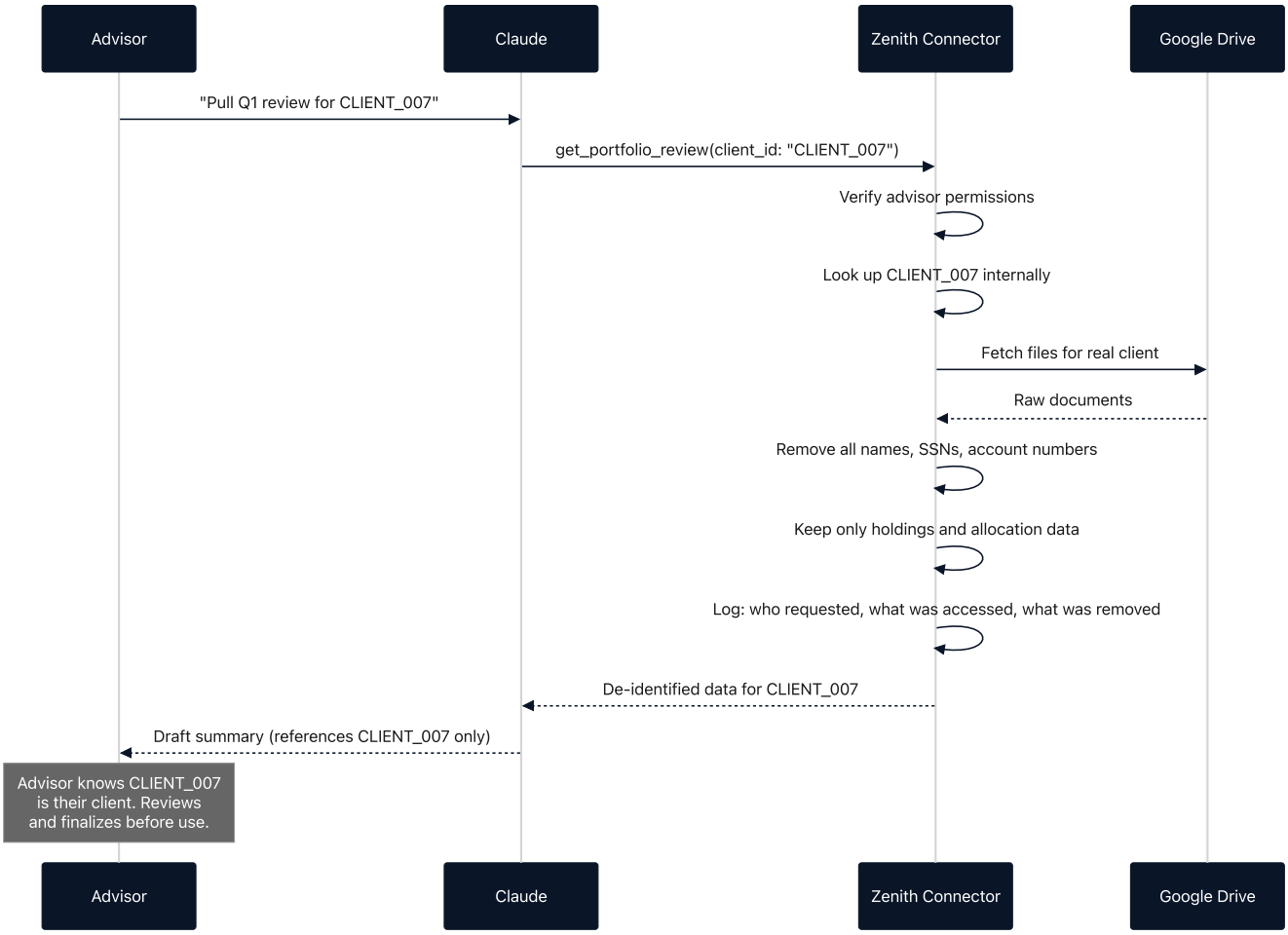

Figure 3 — End-to-end workflow. The advisor types only a code number. Claude never sees a name.

7. APPROVED CONNECTORS FOR ZENITH

Only the following firm-built, firm-hosted connectors are approved. Advisors cannot install, create, or modify connectors. Each connector enforces the firm's data policies independently.

CONNECTOR	CONNECTS TO	WHAT IT PROVIDES TO CLAUDE	CLIENT DATA HANDLING
Zenith Drive Connector	Google Drive	Portfolio data, IPS summaries, advisor notes — de-identified by client code number	Full de-identification. All names, accounts, SSNs, addresses removed.
Zenith CRM Connector	Wealthbox	Activity summaries, meeting history, task status — by client code number	Contact details and personal notes stripped. Only structured activity data returned.
Zenith Research Connector	Morningstar	Fund performance, ratings, analyst research	No client data involved. Market data is public.

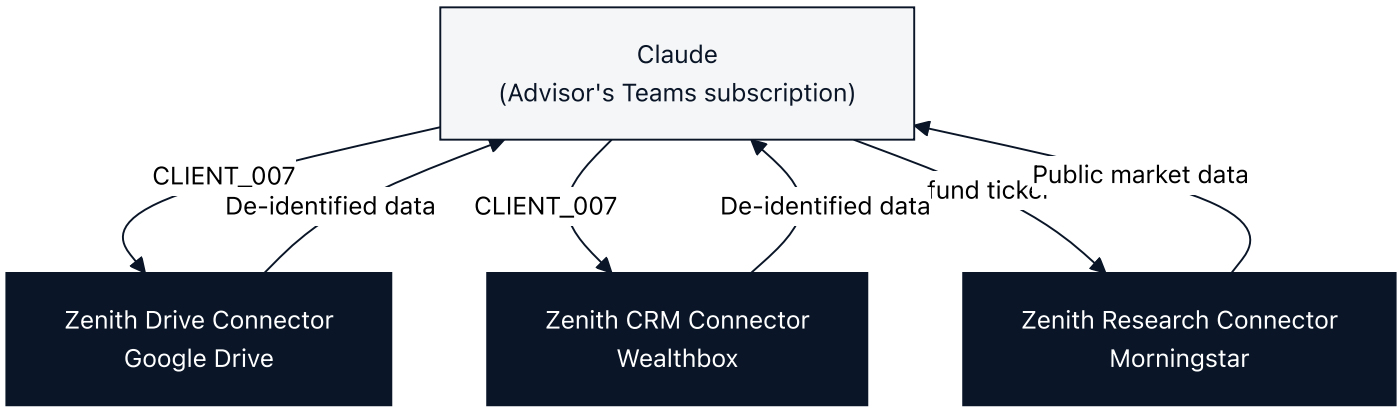

Figure 4 — All connectors (dark) are Zenith-controlled. They determine what Claude can access and how data is cleaned before Claude sees it.

8. ADVISOR ACCEPTABLE USE POLICY

Advisors may use either Claude Desktop (the native application) or Claude.ai (the web browser version). The same acceptable use rules apply to both. However, there is a technical difference in how connectors work across these two interfaces:

INTERFACE	HOW CONNECTORS WORK	WHERE DATA FLOWS
Claude Desktop	Connectors run on or are configured from the advisor's machine and connect directly to Zenith's connector server	Data flows: Zenith connector → advisor's machine → Anthropic. The connector's de-identification happens before data reaches either the advisor's machine or Anthropic.
Claude.ai (web)	Connectors are accessed through Anthropic's cloud infrastructure via the Teams integration	Data flows: Zenith connector → Anthropic's infrastructure → advisor's browser. The connector's de-identification still happens first, but the data passes through Anthropic's routing layer.

COMPLIANCE NOTE

In both cases, the connector strips identifying information **before** data reaches Anthropic. The difference is routing, not security. However, if the firm requires that de-identified data never touch Anthropic's infrastructure at all during transit, Claude Desktop provides a more direct path. The firm should document which interface is approved and why.

Regardless of interface, the acceptable use rule is the same:

THE RULE

Under no circumstances should client data — names, account numbers, documents, statements, or any personally identifiable information — be typed, pasted, or uploaded into any Claude application. All client-related work must go through the firm's approved connectors using client code numbers.

Permitted: Use Claude directly

ACTIVITY	EXAMPLE
General research	"Explain the tax implications of Roth conversions"
Regulatory questions	"Summarize FINRA's 2025 guidance on AI use"

ACTIVITY	EXAMPLE
Market analysis	"Compare municipal bond yields across states"
Template drafting	"Write a template for a quarterly review cover letter"
Approved internal company data See definition below	"Summarize our Q1 revenue report" or "Review the compliance checklist"
Internal process work	"Help me write an agenda for the team meeting"
Learning	"Explain how direct indexing works"

DEFINING "APPROVED INTERNAL COMPANY DATA"

"Approved internal data" means firm operational information that does **not** contain client personally identifiable information. Examples:

Permitted: Firm revenue reports, compliance checklists, internal policy documents, meeting agendas, marketing copy, HR policy drafts, team OKRs, training materials.

Not permitted (must use connector): Any document that names a client, references a client account, contains client contact information, or includes client financial data — even if it is an "internal" document such as an advisor's meeting notes or a CRM export.

When in doubt: If a document mentions a client by name or contains any information that could identify a client, it must go through the connector. When uncertain, do not upload — ask compliance.

Required: Use approved connectors (client code number only)

ACTIVITY	WHAT THE ADVISOR TYPES
Portfolio review	"Pull Q1 review for CLIENT_007"
Concentration analysis	"Check concentration risk for CLIENT_012"
IPS summary	"Get IPS summary for CLIENT_034"

ACTIVITY	WHAT THE ADVISOR TYPES
Document summarization	"Summarize CLIENT_041's planning notes"
Review memo drafting	"Draft a review memo for CLIENT_007 based on Q1 data"

Prohibited: Never do these

ACTION	EXAMPLE	WHY
Upload client documents	Dragging a PDF statement into Claude	The entire raw file goes to Anthropic's servers
Paste client data	Copy-pasting holdings from a spreadsheet	Identifying information enters the AI without being cleaned
Type client names	"Summarize John Smith's portfolio"	The client's real name is now on Anthropic's servers
Share account numbers	"Account 88923455 has too much tech"	Account numbers are personally identifiable
Upload scanned documents	Uploading a scanned tax return image	Images with PII cannot be automatically cleaned

9. CONTROLS & AUDIT LOGGING

ACCESS CONTROLS

- Advisors can only access their own assigned clients
- Document access restricted by type and folder
- Connector verifies advisor identity on every request
- Advisors cannot install or modify connectors

DATA PROTECTION

- Code numbers are the only identifiers Claude sees
- All names, SSNs, account numbers, addresses removed
- Only the data needed for the specific task is returned
- No raw files ever reach Claude

AUDIT TRAIL

- Every request logged with timestamp and advisor ID
- Every file access recorded
- Every de-identification action documented
- Logs are immutable, stored on Zenith infrastructure

AI LIMITS

- Claude cannot access any system directly
- Claude cannot look up who a code number represents
- All output is a draft requiring advisor review
- Claude does not provide investment advice

10. IF AN ADVISOR VIOLATES THE POLICY

Despite training and controls, an advisor may accidentally type a client name, paste client data, or upload a document directly into Claude. The firm must have a clear process for when this happens.

STEP	ACTION	RESPONSIBLE PARTY
1. Detection	The violation may be self-reported by the advisor, flagged during a conversation review, or identified through audit log monitoring. The firm should establish periodic spot-checks of Claude conversation logs available through the Teams admin console.	Advisor / Compliance
2. Immediate containment	The advisor should delete the conversation in Claude immediately. This does not guarantee removal from Anthropic's servers (see data retention below), but limits further exposure within the platform.	Advisor
3. Notification	The advisor notifies their supervisor and the compliance team. The report should include: what data was exposed (name, account number, SSN, etc.), which client was affected, and the approximate time.	Advisor
4. Assessment	Compliance assesses the severity: Was it a name only, or did it include SSN/account numbers? Was it a single client or multiple? This determines whether it rises to the level of a reportable incident under Regulation S-P (30-day notification requirement for breaches involving NPI).	Compliance / Legal

STEP	ACTION	RESPONSIBLE PARTY
5. Vendor notification	If warranted, the firm contacts Anthropic to request deletion of the specific conversation data. The firm should reference its Teams agreement and Anthropic's data deletion procedures.	Compliance / IT
6. Documentation	The incident is recorded in the firm's incident log with: date, advisor involved, data exposed, client affected, remediation steps taken, and whether regulatory notification was required.	Compliance
7. Remediation	The advisor receives additional training. If the violation was systemic (multiple advisors, repeated pattern), the firm evaluates whether additional technical controls are needed — for example, restricting file upload capabilities in the Teams admin console.	Compliance / IT

11. DATA RETENTION ON ANTHROPIC'S SERVERS

A compliance examiner will ask: "What does Anthropic keep, and for how long?" The answer depends on the plan and the firm's agreement with Anthropic.

TOPIC	WHAT THE FIRM SHOULD KNOW
Conversation data	Under Claude Teams, Anthropic stores conversation history so advisors can return to prior sessions. Conversations can be deleted by the user or by the Teams admin. The firm's agreement with Anthropic should specify retention periods and deletion procedures.
Training data	Anthropic's published policy for Teams and Enterprise states that customer conversations are **not used to train AI models.** This should be confirmed in the firm's specific agreement.
Connector data (MCP)	Data returned by a connector passes through Claude's context during the conversation but is subject to the same retention and deletion policies as any other conversation content. The connector itself (hosted by Zenith) maintains its own separate audit log on Zenith infrastructure.
Deleted conversations	When a conversation is deleted, Anthropic's policy governs how long residual data may persist in backups or system logs. The firm should confirm deletion timelines in

TOPIC	WHAT THE FIRM SHOULD KNOW
	its agreement.
Trust & safety retention	Anthropic may retain limited data for trust and safety purposes (e.g., abuse prevention) even after deletion. The scope and duration of this retention should be documented in the firm's agreement.

ACTION REQUIRED

The firm should obtain and review Anthropic's current data processing agreement (DPA) for Teams customers. Key terms to confirm: (1) conversation data retention period, (2) deletion procedures and timelines, (3) confirmation that customer data is not used for model training, (4) trust and safety data retention scope, and (5) incident notification procedures. These terms should be attached as an appendix to this document so it is self-contained for a regulatory examination.

12. HOW THIS ADDRESSES REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

REGULATION	REQUIREMENT	HOW CONNECTORS ADDRESS IT
SEC Exam Priorities 2025–2026 • Source	Document AI oversight and supervision	All connector activity logged. AI output requires advisor review. Connectors enforce task-specific limits.
FINRA Notice 24-09 June 2024 • Source	Supervision rules apply to AI tools	The firm — not Anthropic — controls all data access through its connectors. AI use classified by risk tier.
SEC Regulation S-P Amended 2024 • Source	Safeguard nonpublic personal information	NPI is removed by the connector before data leaves Zenith's infrastructure. Claude never receives NPI.
SEC Books & Records	Retain AI-generated business communications	Every connector request and AI response captured in immutable audit log, retrievable on demand.

REGULATION	REQUIREMENT	HOW CONNECTORS ADDRESS IT
17a-4 / 204-2 • Analysis		
NIST AI RMF Source	Govern, Map, Measure, Manage	Connectors provide governance (policies), mapping (classification), measurement (logging), management (de-identification).
SOC 2 Source	Processing Integrity, Confidentiality	Data minimization and de-identification enforce both criteria.
California CPRA / ADMT Jan 1, 2027 • Source	AI decision systems require impact assessments	Connector logging supports impact assessments and opt-out enforcement.

13. SUMMARY

1. CONNECTORS PREVENT DATA LEAKAGE — THEY DO NOT CREATE IT

Without connectors, advisors copy-paste client data directly into Claude. With connectors, a firm-controlled pipeline strips identifying information before the AI ever sees it.

2. CLIENT DATA DOES NOT REACH ANTHROPIC IN IDENTIFIABLE FORM

Names, account numbers, SSNs, and addresses are removed by the connector. Claude receives only code numbers and financial metrics.

3. THE FIRM CONTROLS EVERY CONNECTOR

Connectors are built, hosted, and maintained by Zenith. Advisors cannot install their own. Each connector enforces the firm's policies independently.

4. ADVISORS USE CODE NUMBERS, NOT NAMES

The mapping between code numbers and real identities exists only on Zenith's infrastructure. Claude cannot look it up.

5. EVERYTHING IS LOGGED

Every request, every file accessed, every de-identification action, and every AI response is recorded in an immutable audit trail on Zenith's servers.

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6. HUMAN REVIEW IS REQUIRED

AI output is always a draft. Nothing reaches a client without an advisor reviewing and approving it.

Zenith AI Connector Governance & Data Security

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